souls and victuals were offered to the poor. But time demanded Babur to be stable again, leaving behind all the mourning.

Babur set an army on horses to march towards Qandahār, which Bāqī Chaghānīānī had been insisting for long. The tourney began through Qūsh-nādir. The day Babur dismounted there, he contracted a fever. It lasted for around a week and he couldn't even afford to open his eyes even for a while. Babur calls it a strange sort of illness.

On 5 July AD 1505, a massive earthquake hit the northern belt, which affected Kābul and Agra.[*] The ramparts of forts and the walls of gardens toppled. The houses of towns got levelled to the ground and people got trampled beneath. Babur has said that the village of Paghmān was affected the worst—where each house fell down and around eighty house heads died because of wall collapses. Babur has described the wrath as follows:[†]

> *Between Pagh-mān and Beg-tūt a piece of ground, a good stone-throw wide may-be, slid down as far as an arrow's-flight; where it had slid springs appeared. On the road between Istarghach and Maidān the ground was so broken up for 6 to 8 yīghāch (36-48 miles) that in some places it rose as high as an elephant, in others sank as deep; here and there people were sucked in. When the Earth quaked, dust rose from the tops of the mountains. Nūru'l-lāh the tambourchī had been playing before me; he had two instruments with him and at the moment of the quake had both in his hands; so out of his own control was he that the two knocked against each other. Jahāngīr Mīrzā was in the porch of an upper-room at a house built by Aūlūgh Beg Mīrzā in Tīpa; when the Earth quaked, he let himself down and was not hurt, but the roof fell on some-one with him in that upper-room, presumably one of his own circle; that this person was not hurt in the least must have been solely through God's mercy. In Tīpa most of the houses were levelled to the ground. The Earth quaked 33 times on the first day, and for a month afterwards used to quake two or three times in the 24 hours. The begs and soldiers having been ordered to repair the breaches made in the towers and ramparts of the fort (Kābul), everything was made good again in 20 days or a month by their industry and energy.*

Babur's illness and the earthquake were bound to affect the campaign to Qandahār. Soon Babur recovered from his illness and the fort was repaired. The campaign was taken up again although the intent was not very clear in Babur's mind. Babur along with his party dismounted at Shniz. Still, he was unable to decide if he should choose to go to Qandahār or to overrun the hills and plains. Jahāngīr Mīrzā and the begs were invited in assembly. Babur took the counsel, and with the insistence of Jahāngīr Mīrzā and Bāqī Chaghānīānī, it was decided to make a move to Qalāt. On the way, Babur came to know that Sher-i-'alī along with Kīchīk Bāqī Diwāna and his supporters were planning to desert him. Babur got Sher-i-'alī killed instantly, and the rest arrested as Babur himself had been observing his disloyalty for long. After a while, Babur let go of the arrested, although he retained their horses and arms.